



△ HIGH DINING

Critically endangered mountain gorillas (a subspecies of eastern gorillas) live high in the Congo, at elevations of 8,000-13,000 ft (2,440-3,960 m). Their diet consists of plants such as wild celery and bamboo.

◁ DENSE FOREST

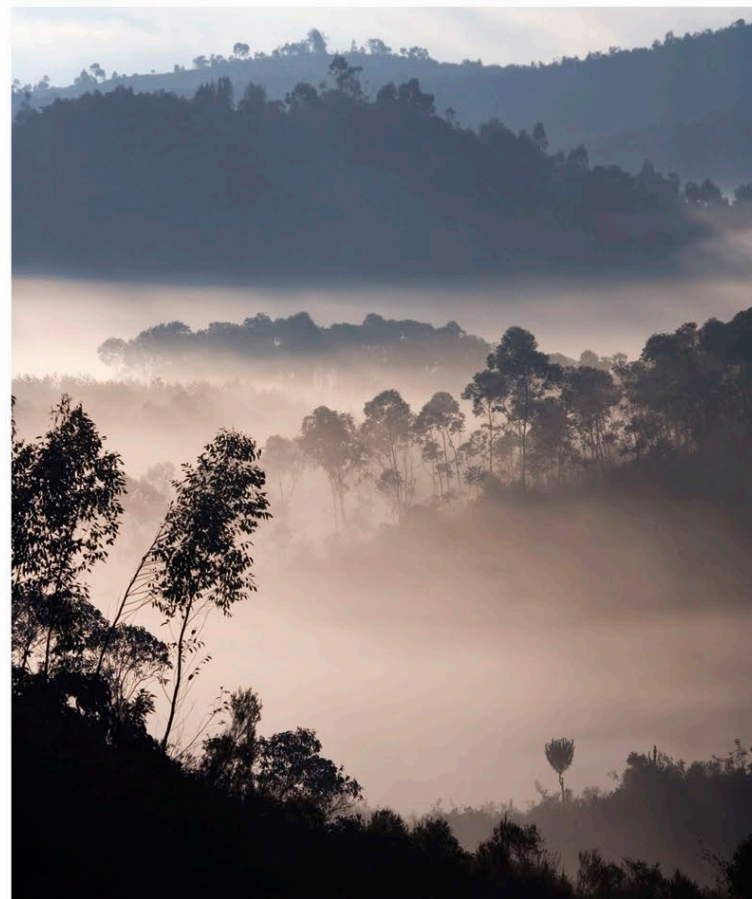
Rain forest vegetation in the Congo is so dense that many sections of the forest have never been explored by humans. In some areas, only 1 percent of sunlight reaches the ground.



Madagascan Rain Forest

A narrow strip of rain forest, where isolation has led to an extraordinary number of unusual native species

Madagascar's rain forest runs along the island's eastern coastal region. Separated from the west by a chain of mountains—the Tsaratanana, Ankaratra, and Ivakoany massifs—and bordered to the east by the Indian Ocean, this area receives more than 100 in (2,540 mm) of rain fall a year. Constant warmth and humidity have created an ideal habitat for tropical plants to flourish, including around 1,000 orchid species, as well as unique animals such as lemurs. Madagascar's evolutionary isolation has also led to an extremely high number of native species: 80–90 percent of its rain forest plants and animals are found nowhere else on Earth.



△ DAWN MIST

Clouds of moisture often linger over Madagascar's rain forest. Around 12,000 plant species are native to the island, which has led to parts of the rain forest receiving UNESCO World Heritage status.